MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer transitioning into DevOps/platform engineering, with 7 years of experience and hands-on ownership of CI/CD, ephemeral environments, Kubernetes namespace deployments and build tooling for three product teams. Builds and maintains GitLab CI workflows and Helm-deployed environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster operated by the platform team. Personal infrastructure experience includes a k3s homelab with GitOps and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Brings an analytical approach to improving reliability and developer workflows, supported by clear technical documentation and cross-team collaboration.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal Hetzner infrastructure), Argo CD

Containers & Linux: Kubernetes (namespace-level experience on shared cluster), k3s, Linux

Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Other: Git, Ansible (basic), AWS: EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, plus artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by approximately 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments for applications, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed with Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team, helping teams prioritise fixes.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored the internal CI guide used in team onboarding, helping developers and QA understand and use the pipelines.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge using short-lived environments deployed through GitLab CI and Helm.

- Ran end-to-end tests against each environment and automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; helped teams prioritise fixes and reduce the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%. Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — preparation in progress; exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet certified).

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mentored two QA interns in 2023. Joined two incident calls as an observer; no production on-call experience.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)